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Shekhar Poudel

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ABOUT ME

An Agricultural Engineering graduate with hands-on field experience in local-level water resource schemes and community extension. I am fully dedicated, motivated, and committed to solving the water crisis in vulnerable farming communities, improving livelihoods, and securing a balanced food-water-energy nexus. Seeking an opportunity to advance technical modelling skills, strengthen water governance capacity, and conduct climate vulnerability assessments.

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

2018/11/01 – 2023/07/31 Dharan, Nepal

BACHELORS OF ENGINEERING Purwanchal Engineering Campus

Core Modules: Soil and water conservation engineering, Hydrology and agricultural meteorology, Bio energies technology (elective), Ground Water Development & Tubewell Technology

Website https://ioepc.edu.np/ | **Field of study** Agricultural Engineering | **Final grade** 73.6 % | **Level in EQF** EQF level 6

WORK EXPERIENCE

AGRICULTURAL ENGINEERING CONSULTANT – AGRICULTURE KNOWLEDGE CENTER, NAWALPARASI (BARDAGHAT-SUSTA WEST)) – 2026/04/15 – Current – PARASI, NEPAL

Website: https://akcnawalparasi.lumbini.gov.np/en/

- Working on Agriculture Development Program With Irrigation (Solar irrigation, Shallow Tube Wells(STW), Irrigation canals, and other pumping equipment as subsidy to farmers)

AGRICULTURAL ENGINEER – AGRICULTURE KNOWLEDGE CENTER, BANKE – 2025/02/10 – 2026/04/13 – NEPALGUNJ 51106, NEPAL

Website: https://akcbanke.lumbini.gov.np/

- Design, estimation and work completion report for subsidized irrigation schemes(STW), and facilitating the distribution of subsidized equipment to farmers.
- Conducted a digital field survey using KoboToolbox to study how subsidized irrigation schemes affect farmers' livelihoods, where technical, economic, and social status, and constraints were examined.
- Participated in farmer focused trainings on farm machinery and irrigation practices.

RESEARCH ASSIOCIATE – NEPAL AGROTECH SOLUTION PVT LTD – 2024/08/25 – 2025/01/31 – KATHMANDU, NEPAL

I simulated FAO's CROPWAT 8.0 model to analyse evapotranspiration and rainfall variability, which proved that optimized irrigation scheduling could dramatically reduce water losses. I have analysed the "Deep Percolation" (recharge) values using the daily soil water balance equation. I found that the existing puddle-irrigation method for paddy cultivation, a major crop in Nepal, was leading to high surface runoff and low soil moisture retention, resulting in very little water returning to the aquifer.

SKILLS

Programming Language

machine learning | Python (computer programming)

Analysis and Simulation Software

CROPWAT, CLIMWAT | PVsyst software | Groundwater Modelling with MODFLOW | geographic information systems | SPAW (Soil-Profile-Air-Water)

LANGUAGE SKILLS

Mother tongue(s): **NEPALI**

Other language(s):

	UNDERSTANDING		SPEAKING		WRITING
	Listening	Reading	Spoken production	Spoken interaction	
ENGLISH (IELTS ACADEMIC- OVERALL CEFR C1)	C1	C1	B2	B2	B2

Levels: A1 and A2: Basic user; B1 and B2: Independent user; C1 and C2: Proficient user

PROJECTS

Estimation of Crop Water and Irrigation Requirement for Major Cereals Crops and Vegetables Using FAO CROPWAT 8.0 Model in the Hill Region of Nepal

Research as Research Associate: The Crop Water Requirement (CWR) and Irrigation Requirement (IR) for major crops, such as paddy, maize, wheat, potato, and cauliflower, in Nepal's hilly region are estimated in this study using the CROPWAT 8.0 model.

Optimizing Solar PV Deployment in Nepalese Universities: Techno-economic and Environmental Comparison of Fixed and Seasonal Tilt Systems

Undergraduate Research: The findings demonstrate that institutional rooftop PV systems can cost-effectively achieve energy independence by reducing dependency on diesel generators during power outages and emissions reduction, offering scalable insights for universities and similar institutions in developing countries.

HONOURS AND AWARDS

Faculty Top – Tribhuvan University (TU), Institute of Engineering(IOE), Purwanchal Campus

I was awarded a 50% tuition fee scholarship in my 3rd semester for ranking 1st among paying students and 2nd overall in my faculty of Agricultural Engineering.

LEADERSHIP SKILLS

2021/04/01 – 2022/05/22

Secretary of Nepal Agricultural Engineering Student's Society

- Advocated for student welfare programs within the Department of Agricultural Engineering.
- Organized capacity-building trainings on AutoCAD, SketchUp, Thesis report writing trainings etc.

COMPETITIVE ACHIEVEMENTS

Manaaki New Zealand Scholarship- Interview Stage(2026)

- Successfully progressed through initial screening, psychometric and personal ability tests, and SOP assessment to reach the scholarship interview stage for just 2 seats allocated to Nepalese applicants.